

Importing customer data into ServiceNow

Based on our project work by the Transform Maps team



SCENARIO Importing, validating and reporting on customer data from an Excel spreadsheet in ServiceNow	1 Entice How does someone initially become aware of this process?	2 Enter What do people experience as they begin the process?	3 Engage In the core moments in the process, what happens?	4 Exit What do people typically experience as the process finishes?	5 Extend What happens after the experience is over?												
Steps What does the person (or group) typically experience?	Receive Excel sheet The sales or support team sends an Excel sheet of new and updated customers	Review the data The admin checks columns like Customer ID, name, email, city and account type	Plan the import The admin decides the target table and which field identifies a customer	Create customer table The admin creates a custom table (e.g., Customer Test) in ServiceNow	Add customer fields Adds string fields such as Customer ID, Name, Email, City and Account Type	Load the Excel file Opens Load Data and uploads the .xlsx file (sheet1, header row 1)	Create import Set table Creates a staging table (e.g., Customer Import) and submits	Create Transform Map Clicks Create Transform Map; source is the Import Set, target is the customer table	Map the fields Uses Auto Map and Mapping Assist so source fields match target fields	Enable Coalesce Sets Customer ID as the coalesce field so existing customers get updated	Run the transform Clicks Transform and waits for the Completed and Success message	Check transform history Reads how many rows were inserted, updated and ignored	Validate records Opens the customer table and checks every record and column	Re-import to test Uploads the same sheet again to confirm no duplicates appear	Create reports Builds a pie chart by account type, a bar chart by city and a list report	Add to dashboard Adds the saved reports to a dashboard for the team	Reuse for new files Next time, loads a new sheet and runs the same transform map
Interactions What interactions do they have at each step along the way?	Email or chat from the sales team, Excel file	Microsoft Excel or Google Sheets	Team chat, ServiceNow PDI (Personal Developer Instance)	Tables > Create New in ServiceNow	Form Layout of the table form	System Import Sets > Load Data	Load Data screen, success message	Create Transform Map button	Mapping Assist, Field Maps related list	Field Maps related list (Coalesce = true)	Transform button, Specify Import Set screen	Transform History page	Customer table list, Personalize List Columns	Load Data, then Run Transform again	Reports > New (Usage and governance)	Dashboard in ServiceNow	Load Data, saved transform map
Goals & motivations At each step, what is a person's primary goal or motivation? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")	Help me get the latest customer data without missing any rows	Help me spot wrong or missing values before the import	Help me avoid creating duplicate customers	Help me build a clean table that matches my sheet	Help me add the right fields with the right types	Help me upload the file without format errors	Help me confirm the staging table was created	Help me link the source and the target quickly	Help me avoid mapping the wrong columns	Help me update existing customers instead of duplicating them	Help me feel sure the transform worked	Help me see exactly what changed	Help me trust the customer data	Help me prove that duplicates are not created	Help me share clear customer insights	Help me keep all the reports in one place	Help me save time on the next import
Positive moments What steps does a typical person find enjoyable, productive, fun, motivating, delightful or exciting?				Load Data makes uploading an Excel file simple	A success message appears after submitting			Auto Map matches most fields instantly	Coalesce updates records automatically	The transform completes with Success state	Clear counts of inserted, updated and ignored rows	All imported customers show correctly in the table	A repeat import inserts 0 new rows and ignores the rest	Charts make customer data easy to understand		The saved transform map can be reused	
Negative moments What steps does a typical person find frustrating, confusing, angering, costly, or time-consuming?	Sheets often have blank cells or typos	Not sure which field is unique for a customer		Each field has to be added one by one	A wrong sheet number or header row causes errors			It is easy to map a wrong column	Without Coalesce, duplicate customers are created			Columns must be rearranged to read the data	Old duplicates have to be removed by hand	Duplicates inflate the report counts			
Areas of opportunity How might we make each step better? What ideas do we have? What have others suggested?	How might we check the sheet for blanks and typos before upload?	How might we give every customer a unique Customer ID?		How might we create all fields faster with a template?	How might we share a ready-made Excel template with the teams?			How might we double-check the mappings before running?	How might we make Coalesce the default for every import?			Could we get an email summary of the transform results?	Could we save a standard list view with all columns?	How might we clean old duplicates automatically?	How might we refresh the dashboard after each import?	How might we schedule imports instead of doing them by hand?	